FT FollowThrough

The Electrical Playbook

What to say from the first call to the five-star review. Copy the lines, put them in your own words, and keep this on your phone.

1. The first call or message

Sound calm, understand the job, and book a next step. Ask:

- What's going on: a dead outlet, flickering lights, a breaker that keeps tripping, or something new like an EV charger?
- Do you smell burning, or is an outlet or panel warm? If so, turn off that breaker and I'll come first.
- How old is the house, and do you know the size of your panel?
- Can you send a photo of the panel with the door open?

> "Thanks for calling [Business], this is [Name]. Tell me what's going on and I'll see how we can help."

> "My service call is [price], and it comes off the work if you go ahead. I can be there today at 1 or tomorrow at 8. Which works better?"

2. Presenting the quote

- Show photos of what you found, like scorch marks, loose connections or a full panel.
- Quote from your flat-rate book, and itemize parts, permit, inspection and grounding.
- Offer options when it fits: a full upgrade, a load-management device, or the work in two stages.
- Write down what happens if you find old wiring behind the wall: a written change order before you do more.

> "Here's what I found, here's how I'd fix it, and here's the price, permit and inspection included. I can start on [day]. What questions do you have?"

3. The 7 objections electricians hear and what to say

Acknowledge it, ask a question, answer honestly, suggest a next step.

1. "Another electrician quoted a lot less."
"That's fair, I'd compare too. Does their quote include the permit, the inspection and new grounding? That's where electrical quotes differ. I'll walk you through mine line by line so you can compare."

2. "I want to get a few more quotes."
"Good idea for a job this size. What matters most to you, the price or the timing? Ask each electrician the same things: permit included, panel brand, warranty and who does the work. I'll check in Thursday."

3. "Can you do it cheaper?"
"I can look at options. What budget are you working with? A load-management device instead of an upgrade, or doing the work in two stages, can lower the price. I won't skip the permit or the grounding, because that's what keeps your home safe."

4. "My brother-in-law can do it for free."
"That's a real saving. Is he licensed, and will he pull a permit? Unpermitted electrical work can cause trouble with your insurance and when you sell the house. I'll leave my quote with you, so you have a licensed option if you want one."

5. “It still works, so I’ll wait.”
“Understood. Have you noticed warm outlets, flickering lights or breakers that keep tripping? Those are warning signs and can become a fire risk. I can fix the urgent item today and quote the rest so you can plan.”

6. “How do I know it’ll pass inspection?”
“Fair question. Has work in your home failed inspection before? I pull the permit, I’m there for the inspection, and if the inspector asks for a fix, I make it at no charge. Here’s my license number so you can look me up.”

7. “Why do you need a deposit?”
“Fair question. Has a contractor ever disappeared on you? The deposit pays for the panel and parts I order for your job. It’s in the contract, and the balance is due once the work passes inspection.”

4. Follow up: day 2, day 5, day 12

Most quotes go quiet, not “no”. Keep each message short and useful.

> **Day 2:** “Hi [Name], it’s [Your name] from [Business]. Did the quote come through okay? Happy to go through it line by line.”

> **Day 5:** “Hi [Name], checking in on the [panel/charger/job]. I have an opening on [day] and can hold it for you until Friday.”

> **Day 12:** “Hi [Name], I’ll close out your quote on Friday. If anything starts flickering or tripping in the meantime, call me and I’ll come out first.”

Panel and EV charger customers compare two or three electricians. The one who answers questions clearly in writing usually wins.

5. Ask for the review and the referral

Ask once the work has passed inspection, and text a direct link to your Google review page.

> “Thanks again, [Name]. If you’re happy with the work, would you leave a quick Google review? I’ll text you the link. And if a friend needs an electrician, I’d be glad to help.”

Put a sticker with your number inside the panel door. It’s where people look when the power goes out.

Three rules that keep you out of trouble

- Pull the permit even on small jobs, and never send an unregistered helper to work alone.
- Carry more than the minimum liability your license requires, with completed-work cover. One fire traced to your work can cost far more.
- Put the scope in writing and price surprises behind the wall as a written change order.

General education, not legal, tax or insurance advice. Rules and prices vary by state, so check yours.
The full start-up guide for electricians: followthroughguides.com/electrical · Questions: info@followthroughguides.com